

SCULPTED BY LARRY

The 5-Day Sculpt Plan

A real first week for someone serious about starting again.

You've started before.

You've stopped before, too.

This is five days. Three of them are training. Two of them teach your body how to recover. Both halves count.

If something here doesn't make sense, hit reply on the email you got this from. I read every one.

— Larry

HOW TO USE THIS

Start any day of the week.

The order matters. Day 1 is lower body. Day 2 is mobility. Day 3 is upper body. Day 4 is mobility. Day 5 is full body.

Don't skip the mobility days. They're not filler. They're how you arrive at the next training day without the previous one still in your hips.

Pick weights you can hit cleanly with two reps in the tank. You're not maxing out. You're learning the movements under load.

Rest periods are real. Rushing the rest doesn't make the workout harder in a useful way. It just makes you sloppier on the next set.

If a movement hurts in a sharp way, stop. Sore is fine. Sharp is information.

This is the plan.

DAY 1

Lower Body

Build a base in your two most important lower-body patterns — squat and hinge.

~50-60 minutes

Goblet Squat

4 × 8 • Rest 2 min

Hold a dumbbell at chest level. Sit between the heels. Knees track the toes. Heavier than it sounds when done well.

Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift

3 × 8 • Rest 2 min

Hinge from the hips, soft knees. Dumbbells stay close to the legs. Squeeze the glutes at the top.

SUPERSET

Dumbbell Reverse Lunge

3 × 8/leg

Step back into the lunge, drive through the front heel.

Lying Leg Curl

3 × 10 • Rest 90 sec after both

Hamstring isolation balances the quad work.

Standing Calf Raise

3 × 12 • Rest 60 sec

Full stretch at the bottom. Don't bounce.

Plank

3 × 45 sec • Rest 60 sec

Brace hard. Squeeze glutes. No sagging hips.

DAY 2

Lower Body Mobility & Flow

Open up everything the lower body day stiffened. Hips, hamstrings, ankles, glutes.

~15 minutes • 2 rounds through the sequence

1. **Cat-Cow** — 45 sec

Slow flow between rounded and arched spine. Breathe with the movement.

2. **World's Greatest Stretch** — 45 sec/side

Lunge → hand to floor → twist. The whole front and back chain in one movement.

3. **90/90 Hip Switch** — 45 sec

Sit on floor, both knees at 90°. Switch sides slowly. Don't force range — earn it.

4. **Couch Stretch (or kneeling hip flexor)** — 45 sec/side

Front of the hip. Tuck the pelvis. You'll feel it.

5. **Standing Forward Fold** — 45 sec

Soft knees. Let the head hang. Hamstrings and lower back.

6. **Ankle Rocks** — 45 sec/side

Half-kneel, rock the knee over the toe. Restore the squat pattern.

7. **Glute Bridge (hold)** — 45 sec

Lie on back, feet flat, drive hips up. Hold and squeeze. Wakes the glutes back up.

Run the sequence twice, slowly. No rest between movements within a round, 60 seconds rest between rounds. If something feels tight, stay in it longer — there's no clock that matters.

DAY 3

Upper Body

Push and pull in equal volume — the foundation of an upper body that works.

~50-60 minutes

Dumbbell Bench Press

4 × 8 • Rest 2 min

Dumbbells over the chest, lower until upper arms are parallel to the floor. Press straight up.

Chest-Supported Dumbbell Row

4 × 8 • Rest 2 min

Lie face-down on an incline bench. Pull the dumbbells to your ribs. Removes the back-strain risk.

SUPERSET

Seated Dumbbell Shoulder Press

3 × 8

Press straight up. Don't flare the elbows.

Lat Pulldown

3 × 10 • Rest 90 sec after both

Pull to the upper chest. Lead with the elbows.

SUPERSET

Dumbbell Lateral Raise

3 × 12

Slight bend in the elbow. Lift to shoulder height — not above.

Face Pull (cable or band)

3 × 12 • Rest 60 sec after both

Pull the rope to your face, elbows high. Rear delts and upper back.

SUPERSET

Cable Row

2 × 10

Sit tall, pull to the belly button, squeeze the shoulder blades.

Dumbbell Curl

2 × 10 • Rest 60 sec after both

Don't swing. Squeeze at the top.

DAY 4

Upper Body Mobility & Flow

Open up everything the upper body day stiffened. T-spine, shoulders, lats, neck.

~15 minutes • 2 rounds through the sequence

1. Thread the Needle — 45 sec/side

On all fours, thread one arm under the other. T-spine rotation, shoulder release.

2. Cat-Cow — 45 sec

Same as Day 2. Connects the spine.

3. Doorway Pec Stretch — 45 sec/side

Forearm on the doorframe, step forward. Chest opener.

4. Lat Stretch on a Bench — 45 sec

Kneel facing a bench, elbows on bench, sit back. Lats lengthen.

5. Wall Slides — 45 sec

Back to wall, arms in a goalpost. Slide arms up and down without losing wall contact.

6. Neck Half-Circles — 45 sec

Slow, controlled. Chin to chest, ear to shoulder, around. No forcing range.

7. Open Book Stretch — 45 sec/side

Side-lying, knees stacked, top arm sweeps open behind you. T-spine rotation.

Run the sequence twice, slowly. No rest between movements within a round, 60 seconds rest between rounds. The movements look easy. They're not. Pay attention to what's actually opening up.

DAY 5

Full Body

Tie the week together. Hit every major pattern at least once. Lower volume per movement so you finish strong, not destroyed.

~45-55 minutes

Trap Bar Deadlift

3 × 6 • Rest 2-3 min

The week's heaviest pull pattern, in the friendliest position. Push the floor away.

Leg Press

3 × 10 • Rest 90 sec

Lighter squat-pattern volume after Day 1. Feet shoulder-width, full range, controlled.

SUPERSET

Push-Up (incline if needed)

3 × 10

Body in a straight line. Chest to floor. Use a bench under the hands if needed.

Cable Row

3 × 10 • Rest 90 sec after both

Pull to the belly button. Squeeze the shoulder blades.

Dumbbell Reverse Lunge

2 × 8/leg • Rest 90 sec

First-half-of-the-week unilateral lower-body work, lighter today. Step back, drive through the heel.

Hanging Knee Raise

2 × 10 • Rest 60 sec

Hang from the bar, raise knees to chest with control. Don't swing. If hanging is too hard, use captain's chair.

WHAT FIVE DAYS DOES, AND WHAT IT DOESN'T

Five days teaches you what real programming feels like.

It doesn't rebuild your body in a week.

If you got through it, here's what you've actually proved: your body still knows how to move under load. You can follow a plan written by someone who knows what they're doing. You can show up on the days the plan says to.

That's not nothing. That's the thing most people fail.

The plan that comes next is sixteen weeks. It looks at your sleep, your nutrition, your training history, your recovery. It scales the volume you can actually handle instead of guessing.

When you're ready, the email after this one will tell you how that works.

For now: rest. Eat enough. Drink water. Get to bed before you mean to.

The body builds when you're not in the gym.

— LARRY

I'm not interested in being your hype guy.

I'm interested in whether you actually got stronger, slept better, and looked at yourself in the mirror with less negotiation.

Five days won't do all of that. Sixteen weeks can.

Either way, you'll see me in your inbox over the next few weeks. Real coaching, not motivational rhetoric.

If you want to talk about what comes after this plan, my calendar is open. The email after the next one will have the link.

— Larry
Tampa, FL
ISSA-Certified Personal Trainer